

FOR REVIEW BY PRACTISING VASTU CONSULTANTS

Vastu Knowledge Base

Draft 2.0 - rebuilt on primary sources

This is the complete rule set behind a commercial Vastu application for the Indian market. Draft 1.0 was assembled from secondary sources and rated **7/10 for knowledge accuracy - not production ready**. Draft 2.0 rebuilds it against the classical corpus and academic scholarship, and re-labels every rule by where it actually comes from.

Product	An app for people about to build or buy . They upload a floor plan, mark North, and are told what to change while changing it is still free.
Why you	There is no universal Vastu rulebook. We are seeking 2-3 reviewers from different schools , deliberately, so that disagreement surfaces rather than hides.
Scope	143 rules across 13 sections, plus 18 open questions
Out of scope	The scoring weights and the 0-100 score. Those are a product invention with no basis in tradition. They are not yours to endorse and we will not claim you did.

The provenance system - read this first

TEXT	Textual. Traceable to a named classical text, cited inline. The strongest claim we make.
DERIV	Derived. Not a verse in any text we could find, but reasoned from the mandala's deity-directions and taught by virtually every practitioner. Most of the room rules sit here - including some we previously called classical.
MOD	Modern or single-school. Traceable to one named school or to 20th-century commercial practice. No classical basis.
DISP	Disputed. Schools genuinely conflict. We have not chosen a side and the app will show the user both.

SECTION 0

What changed since Draft 1.0, and what we need from you

The finding that reorganised this document

The room-placement rules are not in the classical texts. We could not find kitchen-in-South-East, master-bedroom-in-South-West or pooja-in-North-East stated as a verse in Mayamata, Manasara or Brihat Samhita. What those texts actually fix is the *mandala and its deities* - Agni in the South-East, Ishana in the North-East, Nairrta in the South-West. The room checklist is a reasoned extrapolation from that, largely assembled in the twentieth century.

This does not make the rules wrong. Reasoning that fire-work belongs in the fire-deity's quarter is sound within the tradition. But it means we must stop calling them classical, and Draft 1.0 did. Every such rule is now tagged DERIV. **If you can point us to an actual verse for any of them, that rule gets upgraded to TEXT and we will cite it in the app.** That is the single most valuable thing you can give us.

Six corrections we have already made

- 1 **Pooja room.** Draft 1.0 said North-East, full stop. **Manasara reserves the Brahmathan - the centre - for the family deity.** The North-East pooja room is near-universal modern practice, but the classical position is the centre. Both are now recorded.
- 2 **South-facing homes.** Draft 1.0 was already sceptical of the folk prejudice. Confirmed and hardened: multiple senior consultants call it a myth outright, Kerala practice is lenient on south, and major south-facing temples exist. **The engine will no longer penalise a facing direction at all** - the entrance pada decides.
- 3 **The entrance.** Direction alone is too coarse. The tradition locates the door on one of **32 padas of 11.25 degrees each**, and only about nine or ten are auspicious. Section 4 is new and is now the most consequential rule set in the product.
- 4 **Zone method.** You flagged our 45-degree pie sectors. Confirmed as wrong for room zoning: the tradition uses a square pada grid. Section 3 proposes a hybrid - a square grid for rooms, an angular method for the door, which is what practitioners and the leading software actually do.
- 5 **Remedies.** Pyramids, rock salt, copper strips, crystals and wind chimes have **no classical basis**. The classical response to a defect was ritual pacification (Vastu Shanti) and structural correction. Section 12 is rewritten and now says so plainly.
- 6 **Flats.** Draft 1.0 assumed an independent house on a plot. Most of our market buys apartments. Section 8 is new.

What we are asking you to do

Be blunt. A rule you correct now costs nothing. The same rule shipped to thousands of homes and found wrong later costs the only thing this product is selling. Specifically: correct anything wrong in the right-hand column; give us a verse for any DERIV rule you can source; tell us what is missing (Section 15 has space); and tell us where we have misrepresented your school's position.

We do not claim Vastu is scientifically established, and the app will not. It presents rules as traditional prescription, never as guaranteed outcome, and makes no health, wealth or fortune claims. That is both an honesty position and a legal one under Indian advertising and consumer law. Please do not soften your review on the assumption that we need the rules to promise results. We do not.

Why the score is absent. The app gives each home a number out of 100. The weights behind it are ours, and no classical text ranks rooms numerically. Your review covers the knowledge base only. If you think a score of this kind misrepresents Vastu, say so in Section 16 - that is worth hearing.

SECTION 1

The classical corpus - what these texts actually contain

Recorded so that reviewers can see exactly what we have and have not read, and correct our reading of it.

ID	RULE / WHAT THE SOURCE ACTUALLY SAYS	PROV	REVIEWER'S RULING
T-01	Brihat Samhita , Varahamihira, 6th c. CE, Ujjain. Architecture spans ch. 53-60. Ch. 53 opens: <i>"We shall now proceed to treat of the science of house-building (vastu-vidya), which has come down to us from the Rsis who obtained it from Brahma."</i> Contains: the Vastu Purusha legend and head-in-NE (v.2-3); house dimensions by caste and rank in cubits (v.4-16); verandahs (v.17-21); house typologies - Sarvatobhadra, Nandyavarta, Vardhamana, Svastika, Rucaka (v.31-41); the 81-square grid with 32 exterior and 13 interior devas (v.42-43) ; foundation stone laid in the NE (v.112). It does not prescribe a room-by-room directional grid.	TEXT	
T-02	Mayamatam , South Indian, c. 11th-12th c. CE, 36 chapters. English translation by Bruno Dagens (IGNCA / Motilal Banarsidass). Covers site selection, soil testing, orientation, dimensions, houses (ch. 27, <i>Griha-manadhikara</i>), first entry (ch. 28, <i>Grha-pravesa</i>), palaces and iconography. Establishes the deity-direction mandala. Prescribes shanti rituals where a defect is found.	TEXT	
T-03	Manasara , South Indian, c. 70 chapters. English translation by P.K. Acharya. Ch. VII (<i>pada-vinyasa</i>) fixes the deities on the directions. Ch. VI: a building should face East or North-East, and never South-East . Ch. XXXVI-XXXVII: residential building and first entry - the Brahmasthan is unfit for building and reserved for the family deity ; rooms are arranged around it, but the arrangement varies by caste and status rather than following one universal grid.	TEXT	
T-04	Samarangana Sutradhara , King Bhoja, 11th c. Principal source cited for the door-pada framework (<i>dvaravinyasa</i>), the gatekeeper deity Dauwarik, and the rule that the mandala is always laid cardinally straight - never tilted (no Vidisha) , whatever angle the building sits at.	TEXT	
T-05	Also in the corpus, not yet read in translation by us: Vishwakarma Prakash, Aparajitaprccha, Silparatna, Rajavallabha, Kashyapa Shilpa Shastra. <i>Reviewers: if any of these settle a rule we have tagged DERIV or DISP, please say which and where.</i>	TEXT	
T-06	Kerala tradition. <i>Manushyalaya Chandrika</i> (16th c., Thirumangalath Neelakanthan Musath, c. 170 slokas) and <i>Thachu Shastra</i> . Uses the Ayadi Shadvarga six-formula proportional system (Yoni, Aya, Vyaya, Nakshatra, Vaya, Vara) and the <i>Nalukettu</i> house built around a <i>Nadumuttam</i> - a literal open central courtyard, the Brahmasthan as built reality. Notably less hostile to south-facing entrances than North Indian practice.	TEXT	
T-07	Academic assessment. Vibhuti Chakrabarti, <i>Indian Architectural Theory: Contemporary Uses of Vastu Vidya</i> (Curzon Press, 1998), finds Vastu is used today <i>"not as a whole architectural programme, but in bits and pieces."</i> Sachdev and Tillotson (<i>Building Jaipur</i>) trace how the tradition was fragmented under colonial rule, then revived and oversimplified during the 1990s property boom. Stella Kramrisch, <i>The Hindu Temple</i> (1946), establishes the mandala and its deity-directions as the authentic classical layer - but writes about temples and metaphysics, not domestic room allocation.	TEXT	
T-08	What follows from T-01 to T-07. The classical layer is: the mandala, the 45 devatas and their fixed directions, the Vastu Purusha legend, proportion and dimension systems, whole-building orientation, the open Brahmasthan, the door-pada framework, and site examination. The room checklist is not in that layer. <i>Please contest this if you can.</i>	DERIV	

SECTION 2

The directional framework

The deity-element assignment is the genuinely classical core. Everything downstream is reasoned from it, which is exactly why it must be right.

ID	RULE / WHAT THE SOURCE ACTUALLY SAYS	PROV	REVIEWER'S RULING
D-01	North (Uttara) - Kubera. No element of its own; water-linked, shared with NE. Domain: wealth, career.	TEXT	
D-02	North-East (Ishanya) - Ishana / Shiva. Water (Jal) . The Vastu Purusha's head lies here. Most sensitive and most auspicious zone.	TEXT	
D-03	East (Purva) - Indra. Sun-linked. Domain: vitality, social standing.	TEXT	
D-04	South-East (Agneya) - Agni. Fire (Agni) . Domain: energy, transformation, finances.	TEXT	
D-05	South (Dakshina) - Yama. Earth-linked. Domain: rest, fame, discipline.	TEXT	
D-06	South-West (Nairritya) - Nirrti / Nairrta (also Pitru). Earth (Prithvi) . The Purusha's feet. The heaviest zone.	TEXT	
D-07	West (Paschima) - Varuna. Water-linked. Domain: gains, savings, learning.	TEXT	
D-08	North-West (Vayavya) - Vayu. Air (Vayu) . Domain: movement, communication, transience.	TEXT	
D-09	Centre (Brahmasthan) - Brahma. Space (Akasha) . Defined by remaining open. <i>Manasara: unfit for building, reserved for the family deity.</i>	TEXT	
D-10	Weight and height principle. North-East kept lightest, lowest and most open; South-West heaviest and highest. Ground slopes toward the NE; water exits NE / N / E. One of the most consistent rules across every school we examined , and it has a defensible physical rationale - drainage, plus morning sun on the lower side.	DERIV	
D-11	Deity variant. Manu Smriti 7.4 gives a different Dikpala list, substituting Surya and Chandra for Nirrti and Ishana. We use the Ashta-Dikpala list above and ignore the variant. <i>Correct for a residential product?</i>	DISP	
D-12	Planetary mapping. Sun=E, Venus=SE, Mars=S, Rahu=SW, Saturn=W, Moon=NW, Mercury=N, Jupiter=NE. We assess this as modern consultant tradition layered onto the classical deity framework, and specific to Astro-Vastu. Not implemented. <i>Should it be? Does including it misrepresent classical Vastu?</i>	MOD	

SECTION 3

The Mandala and how we compute zones

The most consequential engineering decision in the product, and the one you flagged. Please rule on M-05 and M-06 above all else.

ID	RULE / WHAT THE SOURCE ACTUALLY SAYS	PROV	REVIEWER'S RULING
M-01	The Purusha. Lies face-down in the grid, head to the North-East, feet to the South-West, knees and elbows at the South-East and North-West. <i>Brihat Samhita</i> 53.2-3.	TEXT	
M-02	81-pada grid (9x9), Paramasayika - the residential model. <i>Brihat Samhita</i> 53.42 divides the ground into 81 squares by ten lines each way. The 64-pada (8x8) Manduka is for temples and does not apply to us.	TEXT	
M-03	The 45 devatas. Brahma holds the central 9 padas. 32 outer padadevatas hold one pada each around the perimeter (the Paishachika ring). Inner devas hold 2-9 padas each - Aryama, Vivasvan, Mitra and Bhudhar take the larger blocks; Aapa, Aapavatsa, Savita, Savitra, Indra, Jaya, Rudra and Rudrajaya take two each. Total = 1 + 12 + 32 = 45.	TEXT	
M-04	The Vithis (concentric rings). Brahma Vithi (centre) - Deva Vithi - Manushya Vithi - Paishachika Vithi (the outer 32). This ring structure is how the grid resolves to the eight directions plus centre.	TEXT	
M-05	Brahmasthan extent - DISPUTED. Central 9 of 81 (most taught, about 11% of area); central 4 of 64 in the Manduka; or the central one-ninth by area. We propose the central 3x3 of the 9x9. <i>Please settle this - it decides whether a staircase is flagged or not.</i>	DISP	
M-06	How Draft 1.0 computed zones, and why it was wrong. We used eight 45-degree pie sectors radiating from the plan's centre, with a circle for the Brahmasthan. You flagged this. Confirmed wrong: the tradition uses a square pada grid, and the two methods diverge badly near the corners of a plan.	DERIV	
M-07	Proposed replacement - a hybrid. (a) Rooms: a cardinally-aligned 9x9 square grid fitted to the North-oriented bounding rectangle of the footprint. (b) Main door: the angular 32-pada method at 11.25 degrees per pada - because that is how practitioners and the leading Vastu software actually locate a door. <i>Is a hybrid defensible, or does it mix two incompatible systems?</i>	DERIV	
M-08	Rotated buildings. The grid stays true-North aligned and the building sits diagonally inside it; rooms then straddle several padas. <i>Samarangana Sutradhara and allied texts: the mandala is never tilted.</i> Classical texts assume cardinal alignment and advise against angular siting - but real plots are not always cardinal.	TEXT	
M-09	Irregular footprints. Enclose the shape in the smallest cardinally-oriented rectangle; apply the mandala to that rectangle; padas falling outside the built area read as cuts, padas protruding read as extensions. <i>Is this the correct adaptation?</i>	DERIV	
M-10	Rooms spanning several padas - no canonical rule found. Three methods are in use: (a) the room's geometric centre decides; (b) largest overlap wins; (c) any encroachment counts. Practice appears to use (c) for defects in sensitive zones and (a) or (b) for positive placement. We propose computing per-pada overlap and applying zone-specific rules. <i>This is a guess. Please correct it.</i>	DERIV	
M-11	The 16-zone model is a different system, not a refinement. MahaVastu divides space into sixteen 22.5-degree zones mapped to life-aspects. It is angular, not pada-grid. Offering both in one app means offering two incompatible geometries. <i>Is that honest, or confusing?</i>	MOD	

SECTION 4

The main entrance - 32 padas

New in Draft 2.0, and now the highest-weighted rule set in the product. Each pada spans 11.25 degrees, eight to a side. Roughly nine or ten of the thirty-two are auspicious - which is why direction alone was never enough. Framework traced to Samarangana Sutradhara's dvaravinyasa.

ID	RULE / WHAT THE SOURCE ACTUALLY SAYS	PROV	REVIEWER'S RULING
P-01	NORTH side (N1-N8). Auspicious: N3 Mukhya, N4 Bhallat, N5 Soma - wealth, ancestral gain, prosperity. Moderate: N8 Diti. Inauspicious: N1 Roga, N2 Naga, N6 Sarpa (Bhujag), N7 Aditi.	DERIV	
P-02	EAST side (E1-E8). Auspicious: E3 Jayanta, E4 Indra (Mahendra) - success, authority, official favour. Inauspicious: E1 Shikhi (fire, accident), E2 Parjanya, E5 Surya (Bhrisha), E6 Satya (loss, theft), E7, E8 Antariksha.	DERIV	
P-03	SOUTH side (S1-S8). Auspicious: S3 Vitatha, S4 Gruhakshata - fame, prosperity. Moderate: S2 Pusha. Inauspicious: S1 Anila, S5 Yama (death, disease), S6 Gandharva, S7, S8 Mriga.	DERIV	
P-04	WEST side (W1-W8). Auspicious: W3 Sugriva, W4 Pushpadanta - wealth, growth, Kubera. Mixed: W5 Varuna. Inauspicious: W1 Pitra (poverty), W2 Dauwarik (Dwarika), W6 Asura, W7 Shosha, W8 Papayakshma.	DERIV	
P-05	The consequence. Every side has good padas and bad ones. A south-facing house with the door on S3 Vitatha is better than an east-facing house with the door on E6 Satya. This is why the engine no longer scores facing direction at all.	DERIV	
P-06	The one near-universal prohibition. The South-West corner entrance (Pitra / Nairrti zone) is condemned across every school we examined.	DERIV	
P-07	Naming and counting vary between sources. Both the pada names and where the count begins differ across translations and schools. We propose fixing one convention - compass degrees from true North - and documenting it. <i>Which convention do you use? This is where two reviewers will most likely disagree with each other, which is itself useful.</i>	DISP	
P-08	Locating the door on a real plan. Measure the door's centre along the wall it sits in, convert to a bearing from the plot centre, resolve to a pada. <i>Is bearing-from-centre correct, or is the door located by proportion along the wall itself? These give different answers on a non-square plan.</i>	DERIV	

SECTION 5

Room placement

Every rule here is tagged DERIV. Not because we doubt them - they are taught by virtually every practitioner - but because we could not find them stated as verses. If you can source any of them, that is the most valuable correction you can make.

ID	RULE / WHAT THE SOURCE ACTUALLY SAYS	PROV	REVIEWER'S RULING
R-01	Main entrance - governed by pada, not direction. See Section 4. Facing direction carries no score .	DERIV	
R-02	Kitchen - Ideal: SE (Agni's quarter). Accepted alternate: NW. Avoid: NE, SW, centre. <i>North is contested - see W-02.</i>	DERIV	
R-03	Master bedroom - Ideal: SW (the heavy earth zone). Acceptable: S, W. Avoid: NE, SE, centre. <i>The SE bedroom is the one all sources warn against.</i>	DERIV	
R-04	Children's / second bedroom - Ideal: W, NW. Acceptable: N, E, S. Avoid: SE, centre.	DERIV	
R-05	Pooja room - CORRECTED. Modern near-universal practice: NE. But Manasara reserves the Brahmadhan (the centre) for the family deity , and the traditional Kerala Nalukettu builds the house around an open central courtyard. <i>The classical position and modern practice diverge. Which should the app teach?</i>	DISP	
R-06	Toilet - Most-taught: NW or W; S tolerated. Avoid: NE, SW, centre. <i>East is contested - see W-01.</i> Note: classical texts predate indoor sanitation. There is no verse about toilets. Every toilet rule is an extrapolation from drainage and waste principles.	DERIV	
R-07	Living room - Ideal: N, E, NE. Acceptable: W, NW. Avoid: SW, centre.	DERIV	
R-08	Staircase - Ideal: S, SW, W. Acceptable: NW. Avoid: NE (financial loss), centre.	DERIV	
R-09	Study - Ideal: W, NW. Acceptable: N, E, NE. Avoid: S, SW. User faces E or N when working.	DERIV	
R-10	Dining - Ideal: W. Acceptable: N, E.	DERIV	
R-11	Store room - Ideal: SW, W, S. Avoid: NE.	DERIV	
R-12	Guest bedroom - Ideal: NW. Acceptable: W.	DERIV	
R-13	Garage / parking - Ideal: NW, SE. Avoid: NE, SW.	DERIV	
R-14	Balcony / terrace - Ideal: N, E, NE. Avoid: SW.	DERIV	
R-15	Basement - Traditionally discouraged altogether. MahaVastu permits it in S and W-facing plots. <i>Single-school divergence.</i>	MOD	
R-16	Courtyard. The traditional treatment of the centre is an open courtyard - the Kerala Nadumuttam. Not a rule we can apply to a modern flat, but it is what the Brahmadhan actually was.	TEXT	

SECTION 6

Plot and site

Entirely new in Draft 2.0. For an audience that has not built yet, these matter more than any remedy - they are decisions still open to them.

ID	RULE / WHAT THE SOURCE ACTUALLY SAYS	PROV	REVIEWER'S RULING
L-01	Plot shape. Square or rectangular = auspicious. Aspect ratio ideally within 1:2. A measurable test in wide use: the NE-SW diagonal should exceed the NW-SE diagonal.	DERIV	
L-02	Gaumukhi (cow-faced) - narrow at the front, wider at the rear. Suited to residential , best when the broad part lies NE and the road is on the S or W.	DERIV	
L-03	Shermukhi / Simhamukhi (lion-faced) - wide at the front, narrow at the rear. Suited to commercial and industrial , best when the broad part faces N or E. <i>Considered unsuitable for a home.</i>	DERIV	
L-04	Other shapes. Triangular - fire, disputes; avoided for residential. Circular, oval, wheel-shaped - generally held inauspicious for a home. L-shaped - treated as a rectangle with a cut; judged by which zone is missing.	DERIV	
L-05	Extensions - the good ones. NE extension is the most auspicious of all (Ishanya; keep it open, only light planting). N and E extensions generally beneficial.	DERIV	
L-06	Extensions - the harmful ones. SW extension - serious defect (instability, health, longevity). SE extension - excess fire (accidents, health of women in the house). NW extension - restlessness, relationship strain.	DERIV	
L-07	Cuts (truncations). A cut in the NE is a major defect - loss of prosperity. Cuts are read by which deity's pada is missing.	DERIV	
L-08	Measuring an extension or cut. Rule of thumb in wide use: the protruding or missing portion counts as a true extension or cut if it exceeds half the plot side, measured from the centre. Under roughly 5-10% of area it is treated as minor. <i>These thresholds are consultant heuristics with no textual basis. Please give us better ones.</i>	MOD	
L-09	Dissent worth recording. At least one school (VastuEnergetics) holds that all extensions are negative, including the NE. A minority position, but it contradicts L-05 directly.	DISP	
L-10	Veedhi Shoola (road thrust). From <i>vithi</i> (road) + <i>shula</i> (spear) - a road pointing directly at the plot. Practitioners attribute the concept to Mayamatam and Manasara; we could not verify the citation and flag it as unconfirmed. Auspicious when the thrust comes from NE, N or E (fame, power, wealth). Inauspicious from S, SW, SE or NW. SW and S thrusts are held worst.	DERIV	
L-11	Veedhi Shoola - genuine dispute. Some hold that any road-arrow wounds the plot regardless of direction, contradicting L-10 entirely. <i>Which is your position?</i>	DISP	
L-12	Veedhi Shoola remedies. A thicker or C-shaped compound wall facing the thrust; tall trees against a S or SW hit; a setback or gap; or converting the struck portion into a separate shop. <i>Note this rule maps onto real physical factors - headlight glare, noise, dust, accident exposure - which is worth stating honestly.</i>	DERIV	
L-13	Roads. A road on the N or E is generally held best. Roads on all four sides are excellent for both residential and commercial.	DERIV	
L-14	Facing direction - CORRECTED. South-facing and west-facing plots are not inherently inauspicious. Multiple senior consultants call this a myth outright; Kerala practice is lenient on south; major south-facing temples exist (Kedarnath, Mahakaleshwar). The entrance pada is the determinant, not the facing. <i>Do you agree? This correction removes a belief many of our users will arrive holding.</i>	DISP	
L-15	Slope and drainage. Ground slopes down toward the NE; SW is the highest point; water flows toward and exits at NE, N or E. Consistent across every school examined, and physically sensible.	DERIV	
L-16	Compound wall. South and west walls higher and thicker than north and east. Gate placed on an auspicious pada. The wall should not touch the house. More open space left on the N and E than the S and W.	DERIV	

ID	RULE / WHAT THE SOURCE ACTUALLY SAYS	PROV	REVIEWER'S RULING
L-17	Trees. Large, heavy trees (banyan, peepal, vata, tamarind) belong in the S, W or SW - never the NE or the centre , where they block light and violate the light-NE / heavy-SW principle. Peepal, banyan and white fig should not stand in the NE or directly in front. Tulsi is auspicious in the N, NE or E. Coconut and neem are generally acceptable. Thorny and milky-sap trees are avoided near the house.	DERIV	
L-18	Soil and site examination. The classical texts devote real attention to soil testing and site selection - <i>Mayamatam</i> covers it at length - which modern practice has largely dropped. <i>Should a pre-construction app revive any of this? It is one of the few genuinely textual site rules.</i>	TEXT	

SECTION 7

Building elements

ID	RULE / WHAT THE SOURCE ACTUALLY SAYS	PROV	REVIEWER'S RULING
B-01	Underground water, well, borewell - NE, N or E. Avoid SW, SE, centre.	DERIV	
B-02	Overhead water tank - SW or W (heavy, high). Avoid NE, SE, centre.	DERIV	
B-03	Septic tank - most-taught: NW, or a spot just east-of-SE or west-of-NW. Avoid the NE, the exact SW corner, the centre, directly in front of the entrance, and under the stairs. Kept underground, away from the house and the well.	DERIV	
B-04	Septic tank - GENUINE CONFLICT. Sources disagree squarely on N vs NW vs SE . Some forbid the North outright; others permit N or NW depending on the facing. We have not hard-coded an answer. <i>This is one of the sharpest conflicts we found. Please rule.</i>	DISP	
B-05	Staircase placement - S, SW or W. Never NE or centre.	DERIV	
B-06	Staircase direction - ascends clockwise, ideally E to W or N to S.	DERIV	
B-07	Number of steps - odd (9, 11, 15, 21), never ending in zero. The stated rationale is that one begins and should end the climb on the right foot.	DERIV	
B-08	Under the stairs - a store is acceptable; a pooja room is not; a toilet is best avoided.	DERIV	
B-09	External staircase - SE facing east, SW facing west or south, NW facing north. Should not face the main door directly.	DERIV	
B-10	Kitchen platform - the cook faces East.	DERIV	
B-11	Bed - head to the South (best) or East. See W-05 for the full dispute.	DERIV	
B-12	Brahmasthan - carries no weight: no staircase, no toilet, no pillar, no heavy fixture. <i>Manasara: unfit for building.</i>	TEXT	
B-13	Doors and windows - more openings on the N and E than the S and W.	DERIV	
B-14	Pooja - detail. Idols raised about six inches off the floor. Never inside a bedroom, under a staircase, or sharing a wall with a toilet. <i>Idol facing is disputed - see W-06.</i>	DERIV	

SECTION 8

Flats and apartments

New in Draft 2.0, and commercially the most important section we have. Most of our market buys a flat, not a plot - yet almost every Vastu rule is written for an independent house on land.

ID	RULE / WHAT THE SOURCE ACTUALLY SAYS	PROV	REVIEWER'S RULING
A-01	Two levels of analysis. (a) The building or society read as one plot - regular shape, entrance E/N/NE, NE kept open, overhead tanks and heavy blocks in the SW. (b) The individual flat read as its own unit, with its own mandala.	DERIV	
A-02	Which entrance governs - the consultant consensus. The flat's own door - the one from the common lobby - matters more than the building gate for the people living in that flat. The 32-pada analysis is applied to the flat door.	DERIV	
A-03	The problem this creates. A flat owner cannot move the building gate, the lift, the shafts or the shared walls. For flats, the app can only report - not recommend layout change. <i>Does Vastu have anything meaningful to offer a flat buyer beyond "choose a different flat"? An honest answer matters more to us than a marketable one.</i>	DISP	
A-04	Floor number, shared walls, high-rise. Handled pragmatically by practitioners, with no classical basis we could find - the texts predate the apartment entirely. <i>What is your actual practice here?</i>	MOD	
A-05	The Brahmathan in a flat. Applied to the flat's own footprint. But a flat has no courtyard, and the centre is often a passage or a wall. <i>Is applying the Brahmathan rule to a flat meaningful at all?</i>	DISP	

SECTION 9

Commercial and industrial

Out of scope for version one, recorded because the client will ask for it. Please review only if you have time.

ID	RULE / WHAT THE SOURCE ACTUALLY SAYS	PROV	REVIEWER'S RULING
C-01	Cash counter - opening toward the North (Kubera).	DERIV	
C-02	Cash locker / safe - in the SW, opening or facing North.	DERIV	
C-03	Conflict. Some sources place the cash counter in the SW facing N, others in the N or NE, others by the shop's facing. Not resolvable from our sources.	DISP	
C-04	Owner's seat - SW, facing N or E, solid wall behind, never with the back to the entrance.	DERIV	
C-05	Heavy raw material and machinery - SW or S. Finished and fast-moving goods - NW or W. Electricals - SE.	DERIV	
C-06	Plot shape - Shermukhi suits factories and commercial premises. See L-03.	DERIV	

SECTION 10

Defects the engine flags

A defect is what the app names as a problem. A false positive damages trust directly, so we would rather flag fewer defects accurately than more defects loosely. Please strike anything that should not be here.

ID	RULE / WHAT THE SOURCE ACTUALLY SAYS	PROV	REVIEWER'S RULING
X-01	Toilet in the North-East. Held the most serious defect across every school examined.	DERIV	
X-02	Kitchen in the North-East. Fire in the water quarter.	DERIV	
X-03	Staircase or heavy weight in the Brahmasthan.	TEXT	
X-04	Cut or missing North-East corner.	DERIV	
X-05	South-West extension.	DERIV	
X-06	Main entrance on an inauspicious pada - particularly the SW corner (Pitra). See Section 4.	DERIV	
X-07	Master bedroom in the North-East or South-East.	DERIV	
X-08	Toilet in the South-West.	DERIV	
X-09	Overhead tank in the North-East / underground water in the South-West.	DERIV	
X-10	Pooja sharing a wall with a toilet, or a toilet or store beneath a staircase.	DERIV	
X-11	Veedhi Shoola from the S, SW, SE or NW. See L-10, L-11.	DISP	
X-12	Heavy trees in the NE or the centre.	DERIV	
X-13	Mirror reflecting the bed / beam over a bed or desk. <i>We can find no classical basis for either. Both may be modern. Please rule.</i>	MOD	
X-14	Removed in Draft 2.0: "south-facing house". No longer flagged. See L-14.	DISP	

SECTION 11

Remedies - rewritten

The most-corrected section in Draft 2.0. You told us these were largely modern. Research confirmed it, and went further than we expected.

What the classical texts actually prescribe. The classical response to a defect was **ritual pacification and structural correction** - not an object placed in a corner. Mayamatam prescribes shanti rituals where a defect is found. Vastu Shanti, Vastu Puja and Homa - Ganapati puja, Vastu Purusha sthapanam, Navagraha shanti, directional offerings - are the traditional remedy, together with actually rebuilding the fault. There appears to be **no classical concept of a non-demolition gadget remedy at all.**

ID	RULE / WHAT THE SOURCE ACTUALLY SAYS	PROV	REVIEWER'S RULING
Y-01	Vastu Shanti / Vastu Puja / Homa. The genuine traditional remedy. <i>Prescribed in Mayamatam.</i> Includes ritually seeking the Vastu Purusha's permission before demolishing an old building.	TEXT	
Y-02	Structural correction. The other genuine remedy - fix the fault. For our pre-construction audience this is the whole product: change the layout before it is built.	TEXT	
Y-03	Vastu pyramids. No classical basis. Traced to 20th-century "pyramid power" (Bovis, 1930s) fused onto Vastu. Claims of ancient textual origin appear to be marketing.	MOD	
Y-04	Rock or sea salt bowls. No classical basis. Modern; the negative-energy-absorption rationale has no textual source.	MOD	
Y-05	Copper, brass or lead strips and wires. No classical basis. Modern, used to "virtually block" a bad entrance or patch a cut.	MOD	
Y-06	Crystals, wind chimes, mirrors. No classical basis. Largely modern, with visible Feng Shui cross-influence.	MOD	
Y-07	Yantras. A genuine older tantric and temple lineage does exist - but their use as a Vastu-defect gadget is modern-commercial. <i>The distinction matters. Have we got it right?</i>	MOD	
Y-08	Directional colours. NE white/pale blue; E white/light; SE orange/red; S red/coral; SW brown/beige; W white/grey/metallic; NW white/cream. Largely a modern systematisation mapped from each direction's element. <i>Is any of it textual?</i>	MOD	
Y-09	Plants. Tulsi is genuinely traditional. Money plant and lucky bamboo are modern imports, largely from Feng Shui.	MOD	
Y-10	What this means for the product. We will keep the gadget remedies - users expect them and rivals sell them - but label them modern commercial practice, no classical basis, efficacy not established , and rank layout change and Vastu Shanti above them. <i>Is that the right call, or should we drop them entirely?</i>	MOD	

SECTION 12

The schools

Please correct any characterisation of your own school, and tell us if we have been unfair to another.

ID	RULE / WHAT THE SOURCE ACTUALLY SAYS	PROV	REVIEWER'S RULING
K-01	Traditional / classical 8-zone. Rooted in Manasara, Mayamata and Brihat Samhita. Grid-based, deity-driven. Claims authority from the Sanskrit textual lineage. Our proposed default.	TEXT	
K-02	MahaVastu (Khushdeep Bansal, system from the early 1990s). A 16-zone, 22.5-degree life-aspect model. Angular, not pada-grid. A four-step audit plus sixteen non-demolition techniques. Explicitly challenges the traditional mandatory placements (kitchen-SE, bedroom-SW, open centre) as wasteful. Claims authority from case-study empiricism - the founder reports more than 10,000 documented cases, and holds an honorary D.Sc. from Bundelkhand University, Jhansi (2001). <i>Both the case count and the honorary degree are self-reported and not peer-reviewed. We record this neutrally.</i>	MOD	
K-03	Pyramid Vastu. Pyramids as the primary remedy. Modern, remedy-centric.	MOD	
K-04	Astro-Vastu. Vastu combined with Vedic astrology - birth chart, rashi, dasha - to individualise directions per occupant.	MOD	
K-05	Kerala. Thachu Shastra and Manushyalaya Chandrika. Ayadi Shadvarga proportional formulas, the Thalavara body-proportion system, the Nalukettu house around an open Nadumuttam courtyard. Lenient on south-facing. Authority from a living shapathi tradition.	TEXT	
K-06	Tamil Nadu. Agamic tradition; Nirruthi in the SW; kolam and homa remedies.	TEXT	
K-07	Gujarat / Rajasthan - Vishwakarma / Sompura. Prasadamandana; largely temple-focused.	TEXT	
K-08	Bengal and Odisha. Distinct regional traditions. We know least about these and have implemented nothing from them. A gap we would like closed.	TEXT	
K-09	Where the schools fundamentally part. Grid versus angular zones; whether room placement is mandatory or flexible; whether the south is inauspicious; whether the centre must be open; and remedy philosophy - ritual and structure versus symbolic objects. These are not details. They are different systems.	DISP	

SECTION 13

Disputes we will show the user, not resolve

Where schools genuinely conflict, the app shows both readings and lets the user pick a school profile. Please correct any mischaracterisation - and add what we have missed.

ID	RULE / WHAT THE SOURCE ACTUALLY SAYS	PROV	REVIEWER'S RULING
W-01	Toilet in the East. A defect (East is the sun's quarter) versus acceptable in specific east-of-SE / ESE sub-zones.	DISP	
W-02	Kitchen in the North. Not ideal (Kubera and water against fire) versus merely suboptimal rather than a hard defect. NW is the agreed alternate to SE.	DISP	
W-03	Master bedroom in the West. Generally acceptable as a heavy-zone alternative to SW. Low dispute - the SE bedroom is the one everyone warns against.	DISP	
W-04	Main entrance in the South-East. Acceptable on the right pada versus a defect. <i>Manasara says a building should never face SE.</i>	DISP	
W-05	Sleeping head direction. Head-to-North is the ONE point of near-universal cross-school agreement - avoid. Head-to-South best, East good (students), West neutral to mildly negative. But the magnetic-repulsion rationale usually given is folk science, not established. A 2015 PSQI study of 153 students (Mohammadi et al., <i>International Journal of Indian Psychology</i> 2:4) concluded the opposite - that north-south sleeping should be <i>advised</i> to improve sleep quality. We state the rule as tradition and make no health claim. <i>Do you agree with that framing?</i>	DISP	
W-06	Idol facing. Idols on the W or SW wall so the worshipper faces East - or idols on the E wall facing West. Both taught.	DISP	
W-07	Cash locker. North (Kubera) versus SW opening toward North. Possibly reconcilable as "in the SW, opening N".	DISP	
W-08	Brahmasthan extent. See M-05.	DISP	
W-09	Septic tank direction. See B-04. One of the sharpest conflicts we found.	DISP	
W-10	Veedhi Shoola. Directional (some thrusts benign) versus universal (any thrust wounds). See L-10, L-11.	DISP	
W-11	Extensions. NE extension auspicious versus all extensions negative. See L-05, L-09.	DISP	
W-12	Pooja location. Classical centre versus modern NE. See R-05. New in Draft 2.0 - we did not know this was contested.	DISP	

Conflicts we have missed

Any further disagreement a product like this must handle honestly.

SECTION 14

Open questions

Eighteen decisions we cannot make ourselves. Each is currently a guess sitting inside a product we are about to sell. This is the highest-value part of your review.

ID	QUESTION	YOUR ANSWER
Q-01	The big one. Can you source any of the room-placement rules in Section 5 to an actual verse? Kitchen-SE, bedroom-SW, pooja-NE. If yes, which text and where?	
Q-02	Is the hybrid method in M-07 - square grid for rooms, angular padas for the door - defensible? Or does it mix two incompatible systems?	
Q-03	Brahmasthan extent (M-05): central 9 of 81, central 4 of 64, or one-ninth by area?	
Q-04	Rooms spanning padas (M-10): centre-of-room, largest overlap, or any-encroachment? Does it differ for defects versus positive placement?	
Q-05	Door pada convention (P-07): where does your count begin, and which naming do you use?	
Q-06	Locating the door (P-08): bearing from the plot centre, or proportion along the wall? These disagree on a non-square plan.	
Q-07	Pooja (R-05, W-12): classical centre or modern NE? What should the app teach?	
Q-08	Facing direction (L-14): do you agree that south and west facing should carry no penalty, and that the pada decides?	
Q-09	Septic tank (B-04): N, NW or SE? Our sources contradict each other outright.	
Q-10	Veedhi Shoola (L-11): directional, or does any road-thrust wound?	
Q-11	Extension and cut thresholds (L-08): our 5-10% and half-side rules are heuristics. What do you actually use?	
Q-12	Flats (A-03): does Vastu have anything meaningful for a flat buyer who cannot move a single wall? An honest no is more useful to us than a marketable yes.	
Q-13	Remedies (Y-10): keep the gadget remedies clearly labelled as modern, or drop them entirely? Rivals sell them and users expect them.	
Q-14	Mirror-facing-bed and beam-over-bed (X-13): classical, or modern? We found no basis.	
Q-15	Planetary mappings (D-12): include, or does that misrepresent classical Vastu?	
Q-16	Soil and site examination (L-18): genuinely textual, and largely dropped by modern practice. Should a pre-construction app revive it?	
Q-17	What have we missed entirely? Our audience has not built yet, so plot and placement rules matter to us far more than remedies.	
Q-18	Should this ship at all in its current state? If your answer is no, we would rather hear it now.	

SECTION 15

Reviewer details

So we can credit your review accurately, and cite it if a user or a regulator asks where our rules come from. Tell us how you wish to be credited - or if you would rather not be.

Name	
School / lineage / training	
Years in practice	
Primary texts you work from	
Willing to be named in the app?	
Date of review	

Overall opinion

Is this knowledge base fit to be built into a commercial product? What would you refuse to ship?

On independence. We would rather hear that this needs substantial work than be told it is fine. There is no commercial pressure on your answer, and no version of this review that disappoints us except an inaccurate one. We are showing this to more than one reviewer, from different schools, precisely because we expect you to disagree with each other - and we would rather build on a documented disagreement than a false consensus.